

Eggs Benedict Casserole

Makes 10 servings. Start to finish: 20 minutes preparation, PLUS 8 hours unattended refrigeration time, PLUS 1 hour baking time, plus 5 minutes standing time.

For Eggs Benedict:

- 6 English muffins
- 2 packages (10 to 12 ounces total) Canadian bacon
- 8 large eggs
- 2 cups reduced-fat OR whole milk
- 1 teaspoon onion powder
- Cooking oil spray
- 1/2 teaspoon paprika
- Easy Hollandaise Sauce, recipe follows

For Hollandaise sauce:

- 1 stick butter
- 4 large eggs
- 1/2 cup heavy (OR whipping) cream
- 2 tablespoons lemon juice
- 1 teaspoon Dijon mustard

For Eggs Benedict: 1. Cut the muffins into 1/2-inch cubes. Set aside. Cut the Canadian bacon into 1/2-inch squares. Set aside. Whisk the eggs well in a 2-quart bowl. Whisk in the milk and onion powder.

2. Spray a 9-by-13-inch glass or ceramic baking dish with cooking oil spray. Scatter half of the Canadian bacon evenly in the bottom of the dish. Scatter the muffin cubes on top of the Canadian bacon. Top with the remaining Canadian bacon, scattering it evenly over the bread. Pour the egg mixture over the casserole. Cover the dish with plastic wrap and refrigerate overnight, or at least 8 hours, to let the bread absorb the egg mixture.

3. Preheat the oven to 375° F.

4. Remove the casserole from the refrigerator, and uncover it. Lightly sprinkle the paprika evenly over the top. Cover the casserole with foil and bake for 40 minutes. Remove the dish from the oven, remove the foil, return the dish to the oven and continue to bake, uncovered, until and the eggs are set and the bacon on top begins to crisp, about 20 minutes more. Remove the casserole from the oven and let it stand 5 minutes before serving.

5. While the casserole bakes, make the Easy Hollandaise Sauce (recipe follows). To serve, cut the casserole into squares and place them on individual plates. Spoon about 2 tablespoons (or to taste) warm Hollandaise Sauce over each serving just before serving.

For Hollandaise sauce: 1. Cut the butter into 4 pieces and place in a 1-quart glass measure or bowl and microwave, covered with a paper towel, on high, until almost melted, 45 seconds to 1 minute. Remove butter from the microwave and stir until completely melted.

2. Separate the eggs, placing the yolks in a small bowl and setting the whites aside for another purpose. Beat the yolks well with a whisk or fork, then add to the butter and stir well.

3. Add the cream and lemon juice to the egg mixture and stir well. Microwave the mixture, uncovered, on high, until just slightly thick, about 1 to 2 minutes, stopping every 20 seconds to stir with a fork.

4. Remove the sauce from the microwave and stir in the mustard. Makes about 1 1/2 cups

Cook's notes: The sauce may be kept warm in a Thermos container up to 4 hours. Or you can cool the sauce to room temperature and refrigerate it in a covered microwave-safe container for up to 24 hours. To rewarm, cover the container with plastic wrap, pierce the wrap with a knife to vent, and microwave on 50 percent power until heated through, about 3 to 4 minutes, stopping to stir halfway through. Do not allow the sauce to boil.

Nutrients per serving with 2 tablespoons Hollandaise Sauce: 345 calories, 19 grams protein, 20 grams carbohydrate, 21 grams fat (55 percent total calories), 294 milligrams cholesterol, 1 gram fiber, 810 milligrams sodium.

Nutrients per tablespoon (for Hollandaise sauce only): 63 calories, 1 gram protein, trace of carbohydrate, 7 grams fat (90 percent total calories), 52 milligrams cholesterol, no fiber, 46 milligrams sodium.